Neal T. Gillespie

Austin, TX 78729 • nealtgill@gmail.com • (513) 807-1705 • LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/neal01

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Hiring Committee
Allen Public Library
300 N. Allen Drive
Allen, TX 75013

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am applying for the Library Specialist position at the Allen Public Library. I hold a B.A. from Chapman University, which matches the education path your posting describes, and I am actively moving into library work rather than treating it as a change of direction.

The duty I am most drawn to is recommending books, authors and reference materials to patrons. I founded the Free Knowledge Library, an archive that catalogs political literature from across the ideological spectrum. Building it meant reading widely across traditions I do not personally hold, deciding how works relate to one another, and designing a classification scheme that helps a stranger find the right thing. That is readers advisory, practised on a difficult collection, and it is the part of library work I find genuinely absorbing.

I am also comfortable carrying a desk alone. At Chapman University's Fowler School of Law I staffed the registrar service window as the front-line contact, handled opening and closing including transaction records, and processed over five hundred records accurately. In my current role I oversee a physical archive of printed materials, built the catalog behind it, and keep the statistics on how it gets used.

The posted schedule, including both weekend afternoons and a Thursday evening, works for me, and I hold a valid Texas driver's license. I am able to relocate. I have family in Southern California who can host me during an interim move, and I am willing to go anywhere in Texas a position requires.

I have begun the ALA's Library Support Staff Certification and start a Library and Information Services certificate in the spring. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Neal T. Gillespie